

FinanceCoach- User Guide

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Introduction

1.1 The Purpose of this guide

This guide explains how to install, set up, and use the FinanceCoach mobile application. It provides step-by-step instructions for using the main features of the app, including budgeting, expense tracking, goal setting, and the AI financial assistant.

This manual is intended for general users with basic smartphone knowledge. No technical background is required.

1.2 What is FinanceCoach?

FinanceCoach is a mobile budgeting application designed to help users:

- Create a secure personal account
- Track income and expenses
- Set and monitor savings goals
- View real-time budget updates
- Receive financial guidance through an AI assistant

User data is securely stored using Firebase cloud services, allowing access across devices.

Getting Started

2.1 Installation

If running via emulator:

1. Open the project in Flutter.
2. Run the application using flutter run.
3. The app will launch on the device or emulator.

If distributed as APK:

1. Download the application file.
2. Install on your Android device.
3. Open the app from your home screen.

2.2 Creating an Account

Before using the application, users must register an account.

Steps:

1. Open the FinanceCoach app.
2. Tap Sign Up.
3. Enter:
 - Email address
 - Password
4. Tap Create Account.

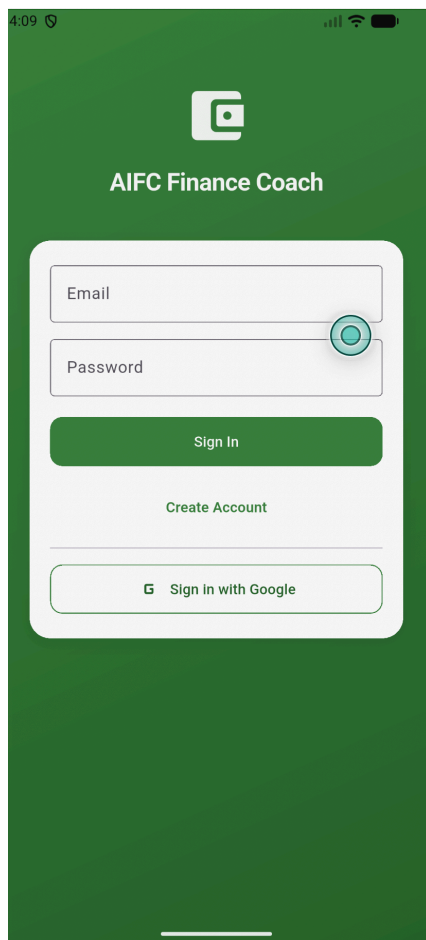
If successful, you will be redirected to the main dashboard.

2.3 Logging In

If you already have an account:

1. Open the app.
2. Enter your registered email and password.
3. Tap Login.

If your credentials are correct, you will be taken to the Home Dashboard.



2.4 Logging Out

To log out of your account:

1. Navigate to the Profile or Settings section.
2. Tap **Logout**.
3. You will be returned to the Login screen.

Your data remains securely stored in the cloud.

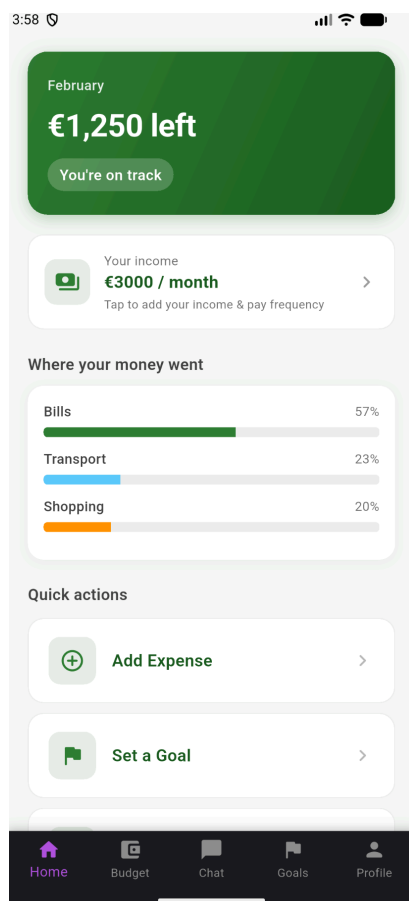
Using the Application

3.1 Home Dashboard

The Home Dashboard provides an overview of your financial status, including:

- Total monthly budget
- Total expenses
- Remaining balance
- Savings progress

This screen updates automatically when financial data changes.



3.2 Creating a Monthly Budget

1. Navigate to the Budget screen.

2. Enter your desired monthly budget amount.
3. Tap Save.
4. Your budget will now appear on the dashboard.

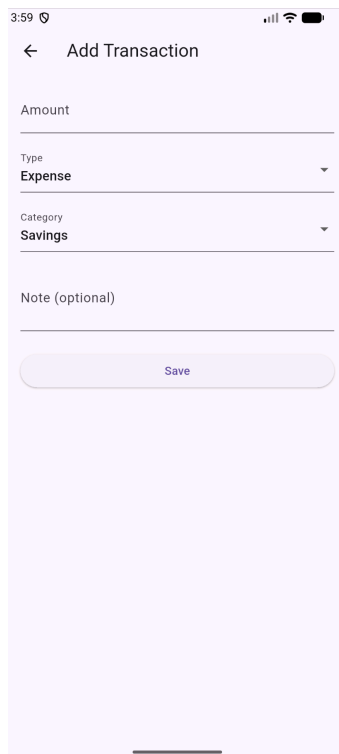
The dashboard will automatically calculate your remaining budget as expenses are added.

3.3 Adding an Expense

1. Navigate to the Expenses section.
2. Tap Add Expense.
3. Enter:
 - Amount
 - Category
 - Description (optional)
4. Tap Save.

The expense will:

- Be added to your expense list
- Update your remaining budget automatically

A screenshot of a mobile application's 'Add Transaction' screen. The screen has a light purple background. At the top, there's a status bar showing the time as 3:59 and battery level. Below the status bar is a header with a back arrow and the text 'Add Transaction'. The form consists of several sections: 'Amount' with a text input field; 'Type' with a dropdown menu showing 'Expense'; 'Category' with a dropdown menu showing 'Savings'; and 'Note (optional)' with a text input field. At the bottom of the form is a rounded rectangular button labeled 'Save'.

3.4 Viewing Budget Progress

On the Home Dashboard, you can see:

- Total budget

- Total spent
- Remaining balance
- Progress indicators

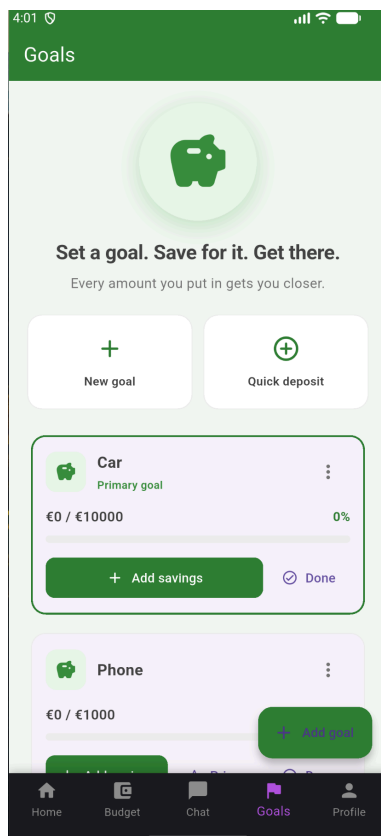
This allows you to quickly understand your current financial position.

3.5 Setting a Savings Goal

1. Navigate to the Goals section.
2. Tap Add Goal.
3. Enter:
 - Goal name
 - Target amount
4. Tap Save.

You can update your progress by adding contributions toward your goal.

The progress bar will visually display your savings percentage.



3.6 Using the AI Financial Assistant

The AI Chat feature provides financial guidance.

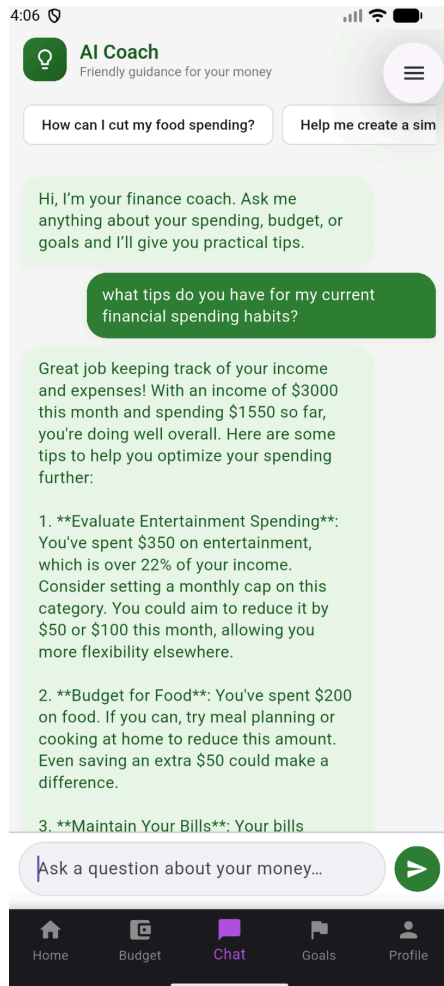
To use it:

1. Navigate to the Chat screen.
2. Type your financial question in the message box.
3. Tap Send.

4. The AI assistant will generate a response.

Example questions:

- “How can I save money as a student?”
- “What percentage of income should I budget for food?”



Data Storage & Privacy

FinanceCoach uses Firebase Authentication and Cloud Firestore for secure data storage.

- Each user has a unique account.
- Financial data is linked to the logged-in user.
- Data is securely stored in the cloud.
- Logging out does not delete your data.

Sensitive information is protected using encrypted network communication.

Troubleshooting

5.1 Login Issues

- Ensure email and password are correct.
- Check internet connection.
- Reset password if necessary.

Ensure that:

- The expense was saved successfully.
- The amount entered was valid.

Restarting the application may resolve minor display issues.

5.2 AI Chat Not Responding

Check:

- Internet connection.
- That the message was sent correctly.

The AI feature requires internet access.

Known Limitations

- No integration with real bank accounts.
- No cloud backup.
- Single-user system.
- Requires internet for AI chat feature.